

Setting Up Single Sign-On (SSO) with SAML

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Single Sign-On (SSO) lets your team log in to CloudDesk using your existing identity provider (Okta, Azure AD, OneLogin, Google Workspace) instead of a separate password.

Setting up SAML

- In your IdP, create a new SAML application and enter CloudDesk's Service Provider metadata URL (found under Settings → Security → SSO).
- Map the required NameID attribute to the user's email address.
- Download the IdP's signing certificate and upload it to CloudDesk under Settings → Security → SSO → Identity Provider Certificate.
- Verify your domain (see below) before enforcing SSO.

Verifying a domain

SSO is enforced per verified domain, not per workspace. Add a domain under Settings → Security → SSO → Domains, then add the provided TXT record to your DNS. Verification can take up to 24 hours.

Important: adding a new domain to a workspace that already has SSO does not automatically enforce SSO on that new domain. You must explicitly enable enforcement for each domain separately once it's verified.

Why did SSO suddenly stop working?

The most common cause of a sudden SSO outage is an expired or rotated IdP signing certificate — not a recent domain change. If your team added a new domain around the same time SSO broke, check your certificate expiry first; certificates typically need renewal every 1–3 years and some IdPs (like Azure AD) can auto-rotate them without notice.

Other things to check: server clock sync (CloudDesk allows up to 5 minutes of skew) and whether your domain has actually completed verification.

SCIM user provisioning

CloudDesk also supports SCIM for automatic user provisioning and deprovisioning. Deactivating a user in your IdP revokes their CloudDesk sessions within 5 minutes.

Related: API Documentation — SAML & SCIM Configuration Reference. Engineering Runbook — SSO/SAML Authentication Outage Response.